

Entertainment took three years to create it, and copies are just shipping now from the manufacturing plant in China.

Second generation of Surface computing

A second generation of Microsoft's Surface computing device is two to three years away. Surface is a multi-touch computer in the shape of a table, with a flat screen that can read multi-touch gestures, as well as content from printed material placed onto the device, thanks to five cameras inside the machine.

Dubbed Second Light, the Surface 2 will build on the original model and have a second projector inside the table computer that can project images onto a layer above the surface of the screen.

In effect, the device will be able to overlay secondary images above those on the screen—such as satellite imagery over a street map or more detailed contextual data on top of images. The machine will also have infrared sensors that interpret gestures and movements without having to touch the screen.

World's first 40nm graphics processors

AMD claims to have developed the world's first graphics processors that harness 40nm process technology: the ATI Mobility Radeon HD 4860 and

ATI Mobility Radeon HD 4830. These feature-rich graphics processors redefine mobile PC entertainment with advanced capabilities including support for the latest Microsoft DirectX 10.1 games, a home theatre-quality HD multimedia experience and energy-efficient features for long battery life at work, at home or at play.

Depending on the performance of the panel or external monitor, laptops that feature these tiny, powerful but efficient graphics engines can run today's most demanding game titles at beyond 1080p HD resolution or play full 1080p HD video with high energy efficiency.

ATI Mobility Radeon HD 4860 graphics will be featured in the forthcoming Asus K notebooks.

Low-cost household robots

In the near future, you could have your own robot that takes care of your household chores and gets you a cup of coffee when you wake up. If things go as planned by IIT Bombay and Microsoft, you could write an algorithm and instruct small robots to do things tailored to your needs. The objective is to popularise the use of intelligent robots in India.

Nex Robotics—a company floated by two IIT Bombay professors and some students—has developed twelve prototypes of such intelligent small robots that can climb stairs, crawl through walls and work the way you want

them to. Low-cost robots developed at the Embedded Real Time System (ERTS) lab of IIT Bombay are priced between Rs 10,000 and Rs 15,000 and come with a robotic platform software called Microsoft Robotic Studio (MSRS).

One such robot, Dominator II, can be used in various defence applications. With its sensor pods and advanced features it is capable of doing all sorts of detection and mapping. The Dominator II platform is used by the Indian armed forces.

Internet connection gets 20 times faster

Wireless Internet connection has just got faster, with CDMA operators offering speeds of up to 3.1 Mbps. These Internet connections are over 20 times faster than the existing wireless broadband connections, and ten times faster than average broadband connections in the country.

At present, broadband is defined as always-on connectivity with 256kbps speed on wired (Ethernet) connections, while the maximum speed available over wireless is around 144 kbps. However, the upload and download speeds do not match the advertised speeds. Users in India, for instance, only get 30-40kbps connectivity on a 256Mbps connection and a meagre 9-10 kbps on a 144kbps connection during peak times, according to Internet Service Providers Association of India president Rajesh Chharia.

Tata Teleservices has launched a plug-and-play device (Photon+) that offers data speeds of up to 3.1 Mbps. It claims that this is 20 times faster than existing wireless mobile technologies. It has also unveiled Power Launcher—an Ethernet-based broadband product that offers speeds up to 100 Mbps.

Reliance Communications too has rolled out a high-speed broadband service, called Netconnect Broadband Plus, which has a downlink speed of up to 3.1 Mbps and a separate uplink speed of up to 1.8 Mbps.



ATI Mobility Radeon HD 4800 series
40nm processor

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